

St. Francis Hospital

East 142nd St. N.Y.City

July 24th, 1921

(17th anniversary of my ordi-
nation - Deo Gratias)

Mrs. M.C. LeDoux
Portland Oregon

My Dear Sister Margaret:

I started a card to you on your nameday - Feast of St Margaret V. and Martyr - July 20 the eve of my own dear Patron's feast day. I did not forget you in my holy office and Mass that day. You will probably wonder what the cause is for my being in the hospital, etc. Well I did not come up here for pleasure, of course. Yet I thank God for the whole experience here since my arrival. No doubt a few details will be interesting, and I hope profitable. I will give you some of them now and tell you their purpose afterward.

Examined by Dr. Edgerton (excellent physician) Saturday night my case was pronounced gangreenous and - a Sunday case i.e. urgent. "Tell Dr. Kirchen to be here at 10 oclock tomorrow", and he said to the nurse(our cousin Joseph Parker) an excellent Tertiary, "We'll give him a whiff of gass and slitt that open.".....

I had counted the hours all night wondering at times if I'd be possibly able to say holy Mass at 6 oclock as prearranged, and how I might hold out till 10 oclock. Thank God I said holy Mass with the great difficulty anticipated.

At about 11 oclock "Parker" came in to tell me that an urgent case of appendicitis had come in as they were about ready for me and --"have a little patience". I had started a couple cards to our Rev Brothers by this time and my pain had become less acute, I think. My most frequently repeated prayer was "God help us!" - sometimes, "Deo Gratias!".

In writing Fr. Edward I wanted to comply with Father Superior's proposition, That I get him to write the Angelus according to a certain beautiful little music we have, with sweet words in German, whose title might be: "The Ave Maria on at Sea" - Here is how I started it:

God's Angel Message

____ u u ____
____ u u ____

Mary received,

____ u u ____
____ u u conceived